

THE BITSTREAM

AN IT & TECHNOLOGY DAILY — AUTOMATICALLY COMPILED

LEAD STORY • BUSINESS & BIG TECH

The Steam Machine is the start of an even more expensive future for game consoles

IT'S NO SECRET THAT just about every aspect of video games is getting more expensive. Game consoles are getting regular price hikes, PC components are spiking in

cost, and the golden age of affordable handhelds is over, all largely due to the global RAM shortage, which has had a similarly costly impact on PC gaming...

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THE FRONT PAGE

AI

Google DeepMind bets \$75M on AI's future in Hollywood with A24 deal

Google DeepMind and A24 are teaming up to build AI filmmaking tools.

TECHCRUNCH AI • JUST NOW

CYBERSECURITY

A new unpatchable flaw in Apple chips opens the door to an iPhone jailbreak

European offensive cybersecurity company Paradigm Shift released details of a flaw and a technique to exploit it that opens the door for hackers to unlock and break into older iPhones.

TECHCRUNCH • JUST NOW

HARDWARE

Valve engineers talk Steam Machine, pricing, and the benefits of massive heatsinks — explain why Valve hardware needs to be a 'self-sustained program'

We talked to Valve engineers Pierre-Loup Griffais and Yazan Aldehayyat ahead of the Steam Machine's launch to learn more about its pricing, engineering, and how the company is handling availability.

TOM'S HARDWARE • JUST NOW

SOFTWARE

The database that refused to die: How Postgres survived its own creators

From academic toss-aside to cloud substrate

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AI

Google DeepMind bets \$75M on AI's future in Hollywood with A24 deal

Google DeepMind and A24 are teaming up to build AI filmmaking tools.

TECHCRUNCH AI · JUST NOW

AI

Nvidia gets all agentic about supercomputing for scientific research

Tireless AI agents could help scientists do research humans alone can't, says GPU giant

THE REGISTER · JUST NOW

AI

Anthropic says Claude may want to see your ID

Claude's chatbot may ask to verify your age and identity "in certain circumstances," such as with a passport or driver's license, according to a privacy policy change.

TECHCRUNCH · JUST NOW

AI

Three things to watch amid Anthropic's latest feud with the government

This story originally appeared in The Algorithm, our weekly newsletter on AI. To get stories like this in your inbox first, sign up here. For those of you enjoying your summer unaware of Anthropic's latest feud with the US government, here's a recap: In April the company said it had built an AI model called Mythos...

MIT TECH REVIEW · JUST NOW

AI

This is the cheapest RTX 5090 laptop deal I've ever seen — Acer's Core Ultra 9 Predator drops to under \$3000 and packs in 32GB RAM and 2TB SSD

For creative professionals, the Acer Predator Helios 16 AI holds nothing back.

TECHRADAR · 1H AGO

CYBERSECURITY

05 stories

CYBERSECURITY

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TECHCRUNCH · JUST NOW

CYBERSECURITY

New lightweight, self-propagating crypto stealing malware delivered by USB spotted by Microsoft researchers - Crypto Clipper script-based stealer hunts for vulnerable wallets

Microsoft details a newly discovered wormlike infostealer called Crypto Clipper.

TECHRADAR · JUST NOW

CYBERSECURITY

ShapedPlugin WordPress Pro Plugins Backdoored in Supply Chain Attack

Multiple WordPress plugins from ShapedPlugin were compromised in a supply chain attack after unknown threat actors managed to tamper with the official release channels and push backdoor code. "Attackers compromised the vendor's build and distribution pipeline, injecting backdoor code into Pro plugin releases..."

THE HACKER NEWS · JUST NOW

CYBERSECURITY

Microsoft says Windows 11 26H2 is coming soon, details upgrade process

Microsoft has confirmed that Windows 11 version 26H2 will be the next feature update and that devices running Windows 11 24H2 and 25H2 will be able to upgrade using a small enablement package. [...]

BLEEPINGCOMPUTER · 1H AGO

CYBERSECURITY

Microsoft fixes AutoGen Studio flaw that enabled code execution

A vulnerability chain dubbed AutoJack in Microsoft's AutoGen Studio interface for prototyping AI agents could let attackers manipulate an agent into executing arbitrary commands on its host system simply by visiting a malicious webpage. [...]

BLEEPINGCOMPUTER · 1H AGO

HARDWARE & CHIPS

05 stories

HARDWARE

Valve engineers talk Steam Machine, pricing, and the benefits of massive heatsinks — explain why Valve hardware needs to be a 'self-sustained program'

We talked to Valve engineers Pierre-Loup Griffais and Yazan Aldehayyat ahead of the Steam Machine's launch to learn more about its pricing, engineering, and how the company is handling availability.

TOM'S HARDWARE · JUST NOW

HARDWARE

Get a half-price precision electric screwdriver set for PC builders and DIYers — ultimate Prime Day 71-in-1 set slashed to under \$50

The TanSon Precision Electric Screwdriver 71-in-1 cordless rechargeable 3.7V portable repair tool set has been slashed from \$99.99 to \$49.99 for Prime Day.

TOM'S HARDWARE · 1H AGO

HARDWARE

Valve is working with AMD to bring FSR 4 to the Steam Machine

The Steam Machine is a cool little console that's about as powerful as a PlayStation 5, according to my colleague Sean Hollister's in-depth review. But one area where it lags behind is with its earlier version of AMD FSR upscaler: It's just not as good as it should be. Yes, it can sharpen low-res graphics [...]

THE VERGE · 1H AGO

HARDWARE

Valve Steam Machine review: Couch gaming unboxed, but not always at 4K

Valve's Steam Machine is nice box to play PC games on your TV, and is well-designed. But you're not getting the latest hardware, despite a starting price above \$1,000.

TOM'S HARDWARE · 1H AGO

HARDWARE

Valve opens Steam Machine reservations — details \$1,049 starting price, randomized queue to stop scalpers, and limited inventory

In a blog post, Valve explained its new randomized reservation systems, new tactics to stop scalpers, and why it has limited inventory.

TOM'S HARDWARE · 1H AGO

SOFTWARE

The database that refused to die: How Postgres survived its own creators

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THE REGISTER · 1H AGO

SOFTWARE

From pledge to practice: Building a more inclusive open source ecosystem

Learn about the progress we've made toward our accessibility goals and how you can help make open source more inclusive.

GITHUB BLOG · 1H AGO

SOFTWARE

Ukraine puts its Russian war trophies online for allies to pick apart

TrophyLab bad for Vlad as battlefield losses spill the secrets they had

THE REGISTER · 1H AGO

SOFTWARE

Inspired by musical greeting cards, DARPA demands tiny, cheap, self-modifying systems

One can't help but see a very clear instance of the triple constraint problem in action here

THE REGISTER · 2H AGO

SOFTWARE

The memory crisis is getting so bad that even retro RAM prices are going to the Moon

Some hardware firms redesigning products to use older DDR2 and DDR3 components

THE REGISTER · 2H AGO

BUSINESS

The Apple Watch SE 3 is just \$199 for Prime Day

The Apple Watch SE 3 is at an all-time low of \$199, making the sleeper hit of last year's Apple Watches an even better value. While the Series 11 and Ultra 3 were iterative updates, the SE 3 was a wide-ranging glow-up that added an always-on display, gestures like double tap and wrist flick, a [...]

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BUSINESS

WhatsApp gets new chief as Meta taps India's CRED founder Kunal Shah and invests \$900M in startup

WhatsApp gets a new boss, as Will Cathcart moves to a new role at Meta, while Shah steps down as CEO of Indian fintech giant CRED to replace Cathcart.

TECHCRUNCH · 3H AGO

BUSINESS

Instagram looks to take on streaming services with longer-form, episodic and live formats for its TV app

Instagram is coming for streaming services like Netflix and Amazon Prime Video as it sets its ambitions for living room viewing.

TECHCRUNCH · 4H AGO

BUSINESS

Lucid Motors' new CEO cuts 18% of staff to 'simplify the company'

The company is also eliminating a production shift at its Arizona factory to align "production plans with anticipated demand."

TECHCRUNCH · 5H AGO

GADGETS

Too rainy or hot to run outdoors? Tired of missing your favorite shows? I've scoured the internet for some of the best Amazon Prime Day treadmill deals

The last 24 hours of heatwaves and rainstorms has me considering giving up running outdoors and getting a treadmill.

TECHRADAR · JUST NOW

GADGETS

This HP laptop is Amazon's best-selling Windows notebook but please don't buy it or you will sorely regret it

Even with a 37% discount, this N100-based HP laptop just doesn't deliver the goods

TECHRADAR · JUST NOW

GADGETS

With GTA 6 pre-orders coming, here are some PS5 and Xbox gaming accessory upgrades that I'd recommend as someone who tests hardware for a living

As a gaming hardware expert, these are the areas I'd recommend upgrading in your setup alongside bagging a GTA 6 pre-order this week

TECHRADAR · JUST NOW

GADGETS

This free tool is helping drivers avoid automatic license plate readers —as fears grow around 'intrusive' new devices that could track your phone, AirPods and smartwatch data

Automatic license plate readers are getting worryingly smart, so drivers and privacy advocates are fighting back with a free tool called DeFlock.

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GADGETS

Almost 80% of data centers constructed in natural disaster zones - data centers are fueling and succumbing to climate risks

Data centers are already under fire for water and electricity consumption - now, they're facing the effects of climate change.

TECHRADAR · 1H AGO

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